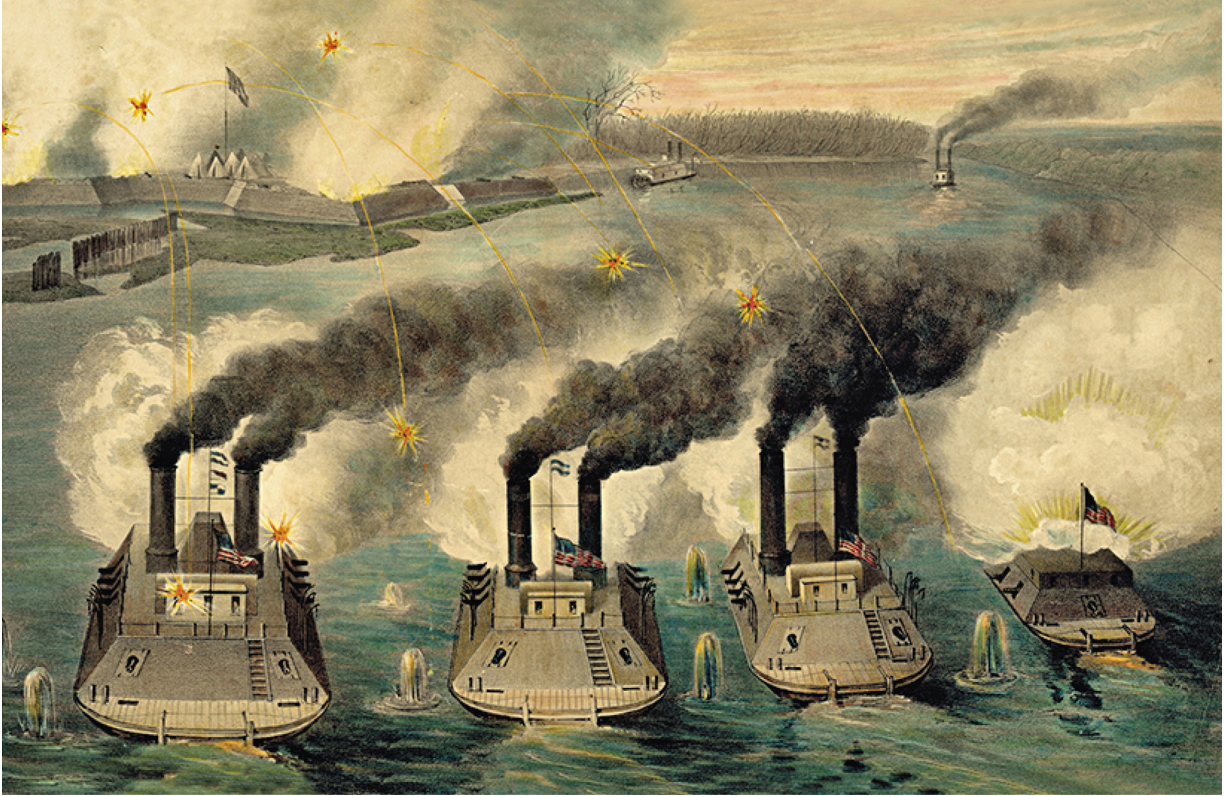




Ironclads in action on the Tennessee River

Union ironclads and timberclads provide the first vital step in taking Confederate-held forts Henry and Donelson in February. Fort Henry on the Tennessee River is given up after naval bombardment; Fort Donelson on the Cumberland River after a grim winter battle.